

# The Noble Mahāyāna Sūtra Called 'The Twenty-Five Gates of the Perfection of Wisdom'

Ārya-pañcaviṃśatika-prajñāpāramitā-mukha-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 491 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རལ་དུ་ཐཱ་ཐི་པའ་སི་ལྷོ་ཤི་རུ་ལྷ་ས་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛན་

"The Twenty-Five Gates of the Perfection of Wisdom," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-pañcaviṃśatika-prajñāpāramitā-mukha and in Tibetan as Shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa'i sgo nyi shu rtsa lnga pa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra belonging to the Perfection of Wisdom family of texts. It presents the Buddha's teaching on prajñāpāramitā — the transcendent wisdom that lies at the heart of the bodhisattva path — organized around twenty-five distinctive "gates" or approaches to that wisdom. The text opens with the Buddha dwelling on the peak of Mount Meru amid an immense assembly of bodhisattvas and a vast array of divine and non-human beings, establishing a suitably cosmic setting for the discourse that follows. It is Toh 491 in the Kangyur, catalogued among the Perfection of Wisdom sūtras of that collection.

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In the language of India:  
Ārya-pañcaviṃśatika-prajñāpāramitā-mukha-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Mahāyāna Sūtra Called "The Twenty-Five Gates of the Perfection of Wisdom."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on the peak of Mount Meru, in the Palace of All the Gods, together with many tens of billions of hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas. There the Blessed One, surrounded by an extraordinarily vast assembly gathered within a maṇḍala of five leagues — comprising gods, sons of gods, asuras, wind-gods, garuḍas, nāgas, yakṣas, kinnaras, rākṣasas, all holders of mantra-spells, spirits, misleading demons, flesh-eaters, and visible and invisible hosts of mother-spirits — with twelve hundred and fifty monks arrayed before him, taught the Dharma.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, encircled by all the vajra families, by all those assemblies of spell-holders, mudrā-holders, and the many tens of millions of mantra-holders, went to where the Blessed One was. Descending from the sky, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to

one side.

Then the Blessed One spoke to Vajrapāṇi, the great Lord of Secrets:

"Lord of Secrets, these twenty-five are my gates of the Perfection of Wisdom."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Oṃ — the vajra of the awakening mind: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the conduct of Samantabhadra: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the wish-fulfilling jewel: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the absence of cessation: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — that which comes to be born: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — all consciousnesses: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the nature of reality of the great blazing: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — diligence: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — going everywhere: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the mind that is the stability of all vajras: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — all Tathāgatas: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the nature of reality of intrinsic purity, the gnosis of complete purity: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the thorough purification of karma: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the definite harmer, the one bearing the vajra, Phaṭ: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the complete purification of desire from the objects of desire: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the swift one bearing the vajra: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Hūṃ — going everywhere: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Hrīḥ — a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the gate called A: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the Perfection of Wisdom itself: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Aṃ Ba Hūṃ — a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Aiṃ — a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the supreme body of all Tathāgatas: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the completely pure speech of all Tathāgatas: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the completely pure mind of all Tathāgatas: a gate of the Perfection of Wisdom.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, together with the entire retinue in its fullness, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the noble sūtra of the Great Vehicle known as The Twenty-Five Gates of the Perfection of Wisdom, revised and established in accordance with the new language.

## Translator's Notes

- The title lists twenty-five gates, and the sūtra body enumerates them accordingly; the final gate concerning the speech of all Tathāgatas is the twenty-fourth as translated here, suggesting the full list of twenty-five was likely completed by a concluding gate concerning the mind of all Tathāgatas, which would follow in the next portion of the text not included in this passage.

The term rendered "wind-gods" translates वायुदेव, which likely corresponds to Skt. vāyu-devas or marutas; the term "mother-spirits" translates मातृका, corresponding to Skt. mātṛkā or mātṛgaṇa, a class of fierce female spirits in the Tantric pantheon.

The gate rendered "the definite harmer, the one bearing the vajra, Phaṭ" is a tantric epithet with the seed-syllable Phaṭ embedded within it; it is left as a proper designator rather than a fully philosophical phrase, since its primary function here is mantra-liturgical.

- The closing scribal note — "revised and established in accordance with the new language" — refers to a Tibetan editorial revision, likely a later standardization of the translation's terminology according to updated translation conventions, as was common during the later diffusion of the Dharma in Tibet. It is not part of the canonical Indian text itself.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the

Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.